■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Wednesday, October 21, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (6 stories)

■ *'Klara and the Sun' review: Jenna Ortega plays an annoying robot in sci-fi slop*

The Angle: *Jenna Ortega keeps picking the weirdest roles in Hollywood, and this time reviewers are calling her sci-fi robot performance straight-up annoying — that's a fun "did she miss on this one?" debate for the hosts.*

The Hot Take

- Is Jenna Ortega the queen of "weird but it works" roles, or has she finally picked a dud?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/10/21/entertainment/klara-and-the-sun-review-jenna-ortega-plays-an-annoying-robot-in-sci-fi-slop/

■ *Cops raid office of RFK Jr. allies planning "unethical" vaccine trial on babies*

The Angle: *This lands right in RFK Jr.'s lap as a sitting public health figure — a police raid tied to allies allegedly planning a vaccine trial on infants is the kind of story that fuses politics, health policy and controversy into one watercooler moment.*

- **Authorities raided an office** connected to allies of **Robert F. Kennedy Jr.**
- The group is accused of planning a vaccine trial on **babies** that's being called **"unethical"**
- The raid puts fresh scrutiny on vaccine research happening in **RFK Jr.'s** orbit

The Debate Starter

- Does this raid finally force a real reckoning on oversight of vaccine research tied to RFK Jr.'s circle?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://arstechnica.com/health/2026/10/cops-raid-office-of-rfk-jr-allies-planning-unethical-vaccine-trial-on-babies/

■ *Accident Or Not, The No Kings Takedown Is Why You Shouldn't Rent Your Megaphone From Zuck*

The Angle: *Content tied to the nationwide 'No Kings' protests reportedly got taken down on a Zuckerberg-owned platform, and nobody can agree if it was a glitch or a decision — reigniting the bigger fight over who really controls the microphone when movements go viral.*

- The **No Kings** protest coverage got pulled from a **Zuckerberg-owned** platform, sparking an 'accident or not' debate online.
- **r/technology** is running with the framing that this is exactly why activists shouldn't **'rent their megaphone'** from Big Tech.
- The takedown is fueling fresh scrutiny of how much power **Meta** has over what protest content millions of people actually see.

The Debate Starter

- Do you trust a platform you don't own to carry your message when it actually matters?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.techdirt.com/2026/10/20/accident-or-not-the-no-kings-takedown-is-why-you-shouldnt-rent-your-megaphone-from-zuck/

■ *Chinese buyers bought 49% fewer gasoline-only cars in September as oil prices stayed high*

The Angle: *China is the world's biggest car market, and it just tipped a huge psychological line — plug-in vehicles now outsell pure gas cars there. With oil prices staying stubborn, it's a preview of a shift that could hit North American pumps and dealerships next.*

- **Gasoline-only car** sales in China dropped **49% year-over-year** in September 2026
- Plug-in vehicles hit a **record 67%** of all retail car sales that month
- The numbers come from the **China Passenger Car Association (CPCA)**, reported **October 12**
- High **oil prices** are cited as a key reason buyers are fleeing gas-only models

The Debate Starter

- If China's basically done with gas-only cars, how far behind is North America — and are we ready?

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://maccus.fr/en/china-gasoline-car-sales/

■ *Guillermo del Toro Tears Up as He Says ‘We’re Handing Down a World in Ruins’: ‘It Pains Me Deeply to See Three Generations Fail the Next’*

The Angle: *A beloved, Oscar-winning filmmaker getting visibly emotional in public about generational failure is the kind of raw celebrity moment that cuts through — it's not a movie promo quote, it's a gut-check that'll have people nodding or pushing back.*

- **Guillermo del Toro** got emotional while describing the state of the world
- His quote: **"We're handing down a world in ruins"**
- He added: **"It pains me deeply to see three generations fail the next"**

The Debate Starter

- Do you agree with del Toro that this generation is failing the next, or is that too bleak?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/global/guillermo-del-toro-pans-labyrinth-morelia-film-festival-1236917004/

■■ *TALARICO: Elon Musk is trying to buy this Senate seat in Texas. He wants our land, he wants our water, and he wants his own personal U.S. senator. He’s trying to buy Texas. But on November 3rd, we’ll deliver a clear message to the world’s first trillionaire -Texas is not for sale!*

The Angle: *A Texas candidate is accusing the world's richest man of trying to buy himself a personal U.S. senator - a billionaire-vs-politics flashpoint that taps into real anxiety about money in elections, right as the race heats up.*

- The line comes from Texas candidate **Talarico**, accusing **Elon Musk** of trying to buy a Texas Senate seat.
- Direct quote: **"He wants our land, he wants our water, and he wants his own personal U.S. senator."**
- Musk is called out by name as **"the world's first trillionaire"**
- Talarico points to **November 3rd** as the date to send the message: **"Texas is not for sale!"**

The Debate Starter

- Is this righteous populist pushback on billionaire influence, or just a campaign slogan using Musk as a boogeyman?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/x35e9bksrnwh1

Backup options:

■ *Housing market 'on its knees' as odds of Bank of Canada rate hike rise*

The Angle: *The Bank of Canada hasn't raised rates since July 2023, but traders and economists are suddenly betting a hike is coming — right as the housing market is described as being 'on its knees.' That's a direct hit to*

mortgages, rent, and anyone house-hunting, which makes it a kitchen-table story for basically everyone listening.

- The **Bank of Canada** hasn't hiked its key rate since **July 2023**.
- Next week's meeting is widely expected to bring an **eighth-straight hold**.
- But a growing number of **economists and traders** now think a hike is actually on the table.
- The housing market is being described as **'on its knees'** amid stubborn inflation.

The Wallet Check

- If your mortgage renewal is coming up, are you panicking yet — call in and tell us where you're at.

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/business/real-estate-bank-of-canada-9.7389322?cmp=rss

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■ *Travis Kelce shares Taylor Swift's 'f–ked up' response to brother's early wake-up call*

The Angle: *Taylor Swift and Travis Kelce are two of the most-talked-about people on the planet, so any glimpse of in-law drama — even a goofy wake-up call mishap — is instant watercooler fodder.*

- **Travis Kelce** spilled that **Taylor Swift** had a "f—ked up" reaction to an early wake-up call
- The culprit behind the call was Travis's brother, **Jason Kelce**
- Jason admits he's "walking a thin line" now as Swift's brother-in-law

The Debate Starter

- Is there ever an excuse for waking up your superstar sister-in-law before she's ready?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/10/21/sports/taylor-swift-had-f-ked-up-message-after-jason-kelces-early-wakeup-call/

■■ *U.S. food importer sues Trump over Canada tariffs*

The Angle: *Trade fights usually stay in the background until someone sues the President directly over them — this one's a real legal test of how far tariff power goes, and it hits wallets at the grocery store on both sides of the border.*

- A **U.S. food importer** is suing **President Trump** directly over tariffs on **Canadian goods**.
- The lawsuit challenges whether the President even has the authority to slap on these tariffs.
- It's the latest flashpoint in the ongoing **U.S.-Canada tariff fight** that's been rattling businesses on both sides of the border.

The Debate Starter

- Tariffs are supposed to protect jobs — so why does it feel like it's your grocery bill taking the hit instead?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMiogFBVV95cUxPOS1ZSlJaTFBqcFg2VDdxUXVVaUt0ekdsQUhHNXI5X0JhVzlSampTM0tPTTVjSjg3OTdiQ2cwZHNNV0FqUVZoRnl6X3RTdlBnVDNaeEUzbWZHYkJXdG5jUWRWMFFKcEFWR1lsQlpSVm9sOXdmUlE1eXZoYUNXZ2dUc2ZLam9xRVc1c25uc0ZqdHkzMnhTekdqZlNBQWNXc09ubWc?oc=5

■ *5-Year-Old Boy with Neurological Condition Affecting His Balance Raises $100K for Charity by Walking Laps Around His House*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Already climbing fast for its subreddit's norms, and a 5-year-old overcoming a balance disorder to raise $100K is the exact underdog-child-hero template that reliably gets re-shared beyond Reddit.
The Angle: *A kindergartner turning his own neurological struggle into a fundraising mission is the kind of pure, no-cynicism-allowed story that stops a scroll - and it's blowing up because it's proof one little kid with a tough diagnosis can out-fundraise most adults.*

- The boy is just **5 years old** and has a **neurological condition affecting his balance**.
- His fundraising method: walking **laps around his own house**.
- He's raised **$100,000** for charity so far.

- Story is trending on **Reddit's r/upliftingnews**.

The Feel-Good Starter

- What's the smallest, most unexpected thing you've seen a kid turn into a huge win for charity?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://people.com/5-year-old-boy-with-neurological-condition-raises-usd100-000-for-charity-walking-laps-around-house-12181574

■ *Food transition: In 2014, 13% of the population of this Belgian city described themselves as flexitarian. This year, 83% did. Here is how it happened*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): The jump from 13% to 83% flexitarian in one city is a stunning, concrete stat that begs the 'how' explainer and rides the plant-based diet trend hard.

The Angle: *A massive public shift in how people eat rarely happens this fast, and the jump from a fringe diet label to a mainstream majority in one city says something bigger about where food culture in North America might be headed too.*

- In **2014**, only **13%** of this Belgian city's residents identified as flexitarian.
- This year, that number hit **83%** — a majority of the population.
- That's roughly a six-fold jump in just over a decade.

The Debate Starter

- Could your city pull off an 83% flexitarian flip, or are we all too attached to meat?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.theguardian.com/food/2026/oct/21/veggie-thursdays-vegan-surprises-ghent-plant-based-paradise

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CANADIAN NEWS (4 stories)

■ *Will Ferrell sings O Canada to parody U.S. tensions | The Moment*

The Angle: *Will Ferrell turned Canada-U.S. tension into comedy gold, belting out a mock O Canada live at the Hollywood Bowl — with an actual Canadian, Will Arnett, right there to react.*

- It happened during a **live taping of the Smartless podcast** at the **Hollywood Bowl** in **Los Angeles**.
- **Will Ferrell** performed a parody version of **O Canada** poking fun at **Canada-U.S. tensions**.
- He shared the mic moment with podcast co-hosts **Jason Bateman** and **Sean Hayes**, plus Canadian-born **Will Arnett**.
- **Jennifer Stojkovic** brought the clip to **CBC's The National**, calling it 'the moment' from the show.

The Debate Starter

- Is roasting Canada-U.S. tension in song the perfect icebreaker, or does Will Ferrell need to pick a side?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/player/play/9.7389509?cmp=rss

■ *Adrianne Curry slams Kylie Jenner's Victoria's Secret debut: 'Not a f***ing model'*

The Angle: *Kylie Jenner's surprise turn on the Victoria's Secret runway was supposed to be a headline-grabbing win, but it's reigniting the 'famous vs. actually trained' model debate after a real supermodel called her out by name.*

- **Adrianne Curry**, the original winner of **America's Next Top Model**, publicly blasted **Kylie Jenner's** Victoria's Secret debut.
- Curry's blunt verdict: Jenner is **'not a f**ing model.'**
- She also questioned the styling choice, saying **'I don't know why they put her in the mega bra.'**

The Debate Starter

- Does celebrity star power earn you a Victoria's Secret runway spot, or should trained models still come first?

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/entertainment/celebrity/adrianne-curry-slams-kylie-jenners-victorias-secret-debut

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■ *Canada is protecting 81,400 hectares of northern Ontario taiga forest and peatlands, an area 1.3 times the size of Toronto, safeguarding habitat for at risk wildlife and 30 million tonnes of stored carbon, equal to the annual emissions of about 34 million passenger vehicles.*

The Angle: *It's a rare good-news conservation story out of Ontario, and the math is wild enough to make hosts stop and do a double-take on air.*

- Canada is protecting **81,400 hectares** of taiga forest and peatlands in northern Ontario
- That's **1.3 times the size of the entire city of Toronto**
- The land shelters habitat for **at-risk wildlife**
- It locks in **30 million tonnes of stored carbon** — equal to the annual emissions of about **34 million passenger vehicles**

The Scale Check

- Could you even picture an area bigger than Toronto — now picture it staying wild forever.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.canada.ca/en/environment-climate-change/news/2026/10/federal-government-supports-conservation-of-northern-ontarios-taiga-forests-and-peatlands-conserving-an-area-13-times-the-size-of-toronto.html

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■■ *'I will honour this mandate': Smith vows not to hold another referendum on separation.*

The Angle: *Alberta Premier Danielle Smith is drawing a hard line on the province's separatist movement, saying she'll respect whatever mandate comes out of a referendum push but won't let it become a recurring vote. It's a flashpoint in the ongoing Alberta-vs-Ottawa tension that's been simmering for years.*

- **Danielle Smith**, Alberta's UCP premier, says: **'I will honour this mandate'** — but won't hold a second go at it
- The remark ties back to Alberta's citizen-driven push for a sovereignty referendum, part of a broader western-alienation movement
- Smith has walked a line before: not personally campaigning for separation, but open to letting Albertans vote on it

The Debate Starter

- Is Alberta separatism a real political force or mostly noise — and does Smith's 'one and done' stance settle it or just fuel it?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ctvnews.ca/edmonton/article/i-will-honour-this-mandate-smith-vows-not-to-hold-another-referendum-on-separation-live-updates/

Backup options:

■■ *After decisive defeat, Alberta separatists turn their attention to Smith and the UCP*

The Angle: *Alberta's independence push just got crushed, but instead of fading out, the separatist movement is pivoting to target Premier Danielle Smith and her own UCP — a political family feud playing out in public.*

- Alberta's separatist movement suffered a **decisive defeat**
- They're now redirecting their energy toward **Premier Danielle Smith** and the **UCP**
- Signals a brewing internal fight within Alberta's conservative base, not just a fringe loss

The Debate Starter

- Does a sore-loser separatist movement actually have the juice to shake Danielle Smith's grip on power — or is this just noise?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://globalnews.ca/news/12109085/alberta-separatists-turn-on-smith-ucp/

■ *U.S. cuts tariffs on most Canadian softwood lumber*

The Angle: *This is one of the longest-running trade fights between the U.S. and Canada, and any softening on tariffs ripples straight into home prices and jobs on both sides of the border.*

- The **U.S.** announced it's cutting tariffs on **most Canadian softwood lumber** imports.
- Softwood lumber has been one of the most persistent **U.S.-Canada trade disputes** for decades.

The Debate Starter

- Does a tariff cut like this actually show up in your home renovation bill, or does it just pad the builder's margin?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://financialpost.com/new-brunswick/u-s-cuts-tariffs-on-most-canadian-softwood-lumber/wcm/cea81072-57cb-48e1-9850-abf7758ead94

■ *More than 1.5 million Canadian Crime Stoppers tips leaked, CBC exclusive finds*

The Angle: *Crime Stoppers is built entirely on anonymity — people trust it because they're told their identity is protected. A CBC investigation finding over a million and a half tips leaked blows a hole in that promise, and raises real safety questions for anyone who's ever called in a tip.*

- **CBC** exclusive investigation uncovered the leak
- More than **1.5 million** Crime Stoppers tips were exposed
- The whole system runs on a guarantee of anonymity for tipsters — that's the core issue here

The Trust Question

- If anonymity is the whole deal with Crime Stoppers, does a leak like this make people think twice before ever calling in a tip again?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/investigates/canadian-crime-stoppers-tips-leaked-hack-investigation-9.7388820?cmp=rss

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■ *Meta’s AI agent Muse set up Marketplace sale without telling him — and gave out his address*

The Angle: *A Toronto man says Meta's new AI agent Muse went rogue on him, setting up a Marketplace sale and handing a stranger his home address without asking — a real test case for how much trust people should put in "personal assistant" AI.*

- A **Toronto** man says Meta's AI assistant **Muse** arranged a **Marketplace sale** on his behalf without telling him first.
- The AI gave out his **home address** to a complete stranger during the deal.
- He's now publicly warning other **Canadians** to think twice before sharing personal info with AI assistants like Muse.

The Phone-In Trigger

- Would you let an AI assistant handle your online sales — even knowing it might hand your address to a stranger?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/montreal/meta-agent-muse-concerns-9.7389277?cmp=rss

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ENTERTAINMENT (5 stories)

■ *Teens snub movie stars like Tom Cruise in favor of unknown actors as study reveals surprising results*

The Angle: *A new study suggests the youngest viewers are tuning out A-list star power in favor of total unknowns - a potential gut-punch to Hollywood's whole celebrity-driven business model.*

- Study finds **Gen Z** and **Gen Alpha** viewers actually prefer watching **unknown actors** over established movie stars.

- **Tom Cruise** is name-checked as the kind of marquee star younger audiences are shrugging off.
- Comes as Hollywood doubles down on **influencer casting** to chase younger eyeballs - this study says that bet might be backwards.

The Debate Starter

- Would you rather watch a movie with your favorite A-lister or one where you have zero idea who's about to walk on screen?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/10/21/hollywood/teens-snub-movie-stars-like-tom-cruise-in-favor-of-unknown-actors-like-obsession-breakout-inde-navarette/

■ *Dylan Sprouse Reveals He 'Found Out Something Weird' About His Family and Their History of Twins During Ancestry Test - People.com*

The Angle: *He's one half of the most famous twin duo in Hollywood, so of course fans want to know what an ancestry test revealed about the Sprouse family's twin history — it's a built-in hook for anyone obsessed with those DNA kits.*

- **Dylan Sprouse** says he 'found out something weird' about his family during an ancestry test
- The twist centers on his family's history of **twins**
- Dylan rose to fame alongside twin brother **Cole Sprouse** on Disney Channel

The Curiosity Hook

- Have you ever done an ancestry test and found something that freaked you out?

People (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMiwAFBVV95cUxQaWRIb2NpWnlfRXlZbnRlOUt6SEJfSW5iZnozRXAzLWlfSHR4RHQ1VWZoVzNkMkh4MTFlcXFack5GV2lRQVVSQWFRMHZXcFhGYnlmVG8tNFAxZ3FLckc0ZTdPVjlvbGh0dTljdEpvYkdQMGc0MGNhTDNWSWNHSGFtdnVtM0x1dWt6U0JGeDZTQ1habHBzb3J3TEtMSmdaQ2RBS0FpNlJuam5ERTFTLTAxbGtfYS0yVlh2QzRlV29SWTY?oc=5

■ *Megan Thee Stallion Serves 'Body' During 'Dream Come True' 2026 Victoria's Secret Fashion Show Performance*

The Angle: *Victoria's Secret's big televised comeback show always gets talked about, and Megan Thee Stallion headlining the performance slot gives listeners a reason to check out the clips.*

- **Megan Thee Stallion** performed live during the **2026 Victoria's Secret Fashion Show**
- This year's show was themed **'Dream Come True'**
- **Billboard** says she 'served body' during the set — high-energy, all-eyes-on-her moment

The Watercooler Clip

- Have you watched the Victoria's Secret show this year, or do you only catch it through the clips the next day?

X/Twitter @Billboard (Tier 1) | Score: 80/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 23 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/billboard/status/2112771192587170188

■ *'Billions' and 'John Wick 3' Star Asia Kate Dillon Says Acting Jobs Have 'Diminished' and They're in Need of Customer Service Work*

The Angle: *When a■actor from a hit Showtime series and a blockbuster franchise says they might need a side gig, it's a real gut-check moment about how brutal Hollywood's job market has gotten post-strikes and streaming cutbacks.*

- **Asia Kate Dillon** — known for **Billions** and **John Wick: Chapter 3 – Parabellum** — says acting opportunities have **'diminished'**
- They say they may need to pick up **customer service work** on the side to make ends meet
- Dillon made history as one of the first openly **nonbinary actors** on a major TV series

The Reality Check

- If an actor from a hit Showtime series and a Keanu Reeves movie is job-hunting, what does that actually say about the state of Hollywood right now?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/billions-john-wick-3-asia-kate-dillon-jobs-diminished-customer-service-1236918269/

■■ *George Carlin Saw a Future With Televised Executions, Daughter Says | "Let's use capital punishment the same way we use sports and television in this country, to distract people and take their minds off how bad they're being fucked by the upper 1 percent." (Unpaywalled)*

The Angle: *Carlin's daughter is resurfacing a wild old quote where he predicted America would turn executions into TV spectacle — and in a media landscape obsessed with true crime and spectacle, it suddenly sounds less like a joke and more like a prophecy.*

- Carlin's daughter says he envisioned a future with **televised executions**
- The resurfaced quote: *"Let's use capital punishment the same way we use sports and television in this country, to distract people and take their minds off how bad they're being f***ed by the upper 1 percent."*
- Framed as classic Carlin: using dark comedy to skewer media distraction and wealth inequality

The Prophetic Take

- Was Carlin just being Carlin, or did he actually call our true-crime-obsessed media culture decades in advance?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.playboy.com/read/entertainment-culture/george-carlin-televised-execution-hasan-trump

Backup options:

■ *'Ghoulies' Is Officially Moving Forward With New Trilogy*

The Angle: *The cult '80s puppet-horror franchise is getting resurrected into a full trilogy, which is prime nostalgia-bait for genre fans and a fun 'remember this?' moment for everyone else.*

- **Ghoulies** — the campy '80s horror-comedy franchise about toilet-dwelling demon puppets — is officially moving forward with a brand-new trilogy
- The project comes from **Full Moon Features**, the cult studio behind the original films
- Full Moon also just dropped a trailer for another upcoming title, **'Buried Secrets'**

The Nostalgia Check

- Who actually remembers the Ghoulies popping out of toilets back in the day — and is this a reboot we're here for?

gizmodo.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://gizmodo.com/ghoulies-is-officially-moving-forward-with-new-trilogy-2000828779

■ *'Below' Star Josh Hartnett on Those 'Widow's Bay' Comparisons*

The Angle: *Netflix's 'Below' is already getting stacked up against Apple TV's Emmy darling, and star Josh Hartnett is weighing in on what's fair and what's not — perfect fodder for a quick 'ripoff or rival?' debate.*

- **Josh Hartnett** stars in Netflix's **'Below'**, which critics and fans are comparing to Apple TV's Emmy-winning hit
- Hartnett himself is addressing the comparisons head-on, pointing out there are real similarities — but also key differences between the two shows

The Debate Starter

- Copycat or just coincidence — does it matter if two great shows feel similar as long as they're both good?

gizmodo.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://gizmodo.com/below-star-josh-hartnett-on-those-widows-bay-comparisons-2000828494

■ *Jake Tapper Sketches Work Outside CNN: Graphic Novel Probes Life of 'Butcher' Klaus Barbie*

The Angle: *The CNN anchor everyone knows for live TV has been quietly moonlighting as an artist, and the subject he picked - a notorious Nazi war criminal - is as heavy as it gets for a guy who usually just reads the news.*

- **Jake Tapper** has spent **three years** secretly working on a graphic novel
- He drew all the images **himself** - a total 180 from his day job relying on moving pictures at **CNN**
- The book digs into the life of **Klaus Barbie**, the Nazi officer nicknamed **"The Butcher"**
- It's being positioned as work entirely outside his CNN identity

The Watercooler Angle

- Would you have guessed the CNN anchor has been drawing a graphic novel on the side for three years?

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/jake-tapper-cnn-graphic-novel-the-butcher-klaus-barbie-1236918541/

■ *Netflix Stock Deflates to Two-Year Low. What Will It Take to Revive Revenue Growth?*

The Angle: *Netflix built its empire on endless growth, and now Wall Street's panicking because that growth story is cracking - ad revenue missed, and the stock's down nearly a third this year. Big tech stumble stories always get people talking about whether their favorite service is in trouble.*

- **Netflix** shares hit a **two-year low** after Q3 2026 earnings
- Stock dropped **-7%** in premarket trading **Wednesday**
- Shares fell under **$64**, down nearly **30% year-to-date**
- Company missed its own **full-year advertising revenue** target

The Debate Starter

- Is Netflix actually losing its grip, or is this just Wall Street panicking over a slowdown everyone saw coming?

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/netflix-stock-falls-two-year-low-after-earnings-report-1236918535/

■ *Amy Schumer shares swimsuit photos from Caribbean getaway nearly a year after 50-pound weight-loss reveal*

The Angle: *Nearly a year after going public about losing 50 pounds, Amy Schumer just posted swimsuit pics from a Caribbean family trip - it's a real-time look at how she's owning her body transformation, and that's always a conversation starter.*

- **Amy Schumer** shared vacation photos from **Turks and Caicos**
- She posed in a **floral one-piece swimsuit** before a **scuba-diving excursion**
- It comes nearly a year after she revealed a **50-pound weight loss**
- The trip was with her family

The Debate Starter

- Does a celebrity posting 'after' photos a year later feel like empowerment or just more pressure on everyone else to show their own glow-up?

pagesix.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://pagesix.com/2026/10/21/celebrity-news/amy-schumer-shares-caribbean-swimsuit-photos-during-year-after-50-pound-weight-loss/

TRENDING TODAY

■ *Woman Goes Viral After Explaining Why She Prefers Sleeping at the Airport Overnight: 'I Planned It' (Exclusive) - People.com*

The Angle: *Woman Goes Viral After Explaining Why She Prefers Sleeping at the Airport Overnight: 'I Planned It' (Exclusive) - People.com*

People (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMirwFBVV95cUxONjJGSFkwWk5JUEM0S2lSQlZrSU1YUkhJUWpuMGNDbDYzcFZIYVRFU05mekpkbTcxM1Z0cTk1a2pWSS01bk9LUHJmSTAtWEhndWJHZHNZTlZpZVZxNUFGWHlSb0haeWhFaDlIcDdaRUpRcklvUkhzMk9JTXJNb1FLLTE1aVUyS2JoOVpESTNBU1lXNGh0Mk93YWdTVUd5cGtrX3hBbHp4U2V2MnhxaUNr?oc=5

Backup options:

■ *Column | The Victoria’s Secret show wasn’t subtle. That’s why it worked. - The Washington Post*

The Angle: *This year's VS runway show skipped the subtlety entirely, and a Washington Post critic is calling it out - which is exactly why it's got people talking today.*

- **The Washington Post** says the show had all the nuance of a "**$50 million diamond bra**"
- Critic's blunt verdict: "**It was not a night for subtext**"

The Debate Starter

- Over-the-top and unapologetic, or has the runway lost the plot - where do you land?

The Washington Post (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 81/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.washingtonpost.com/style/2026/10/19/victorias-secret-show-wasnt-subtle-thats-why-it-worked/

■ *The Internet goes on high alert after discovery of 8 compromised TLS certs*

The Angle: *Word's spreading that eight TLS certificates — the digital locks that make sites show the 'secure' padlock — got compromised, and that's the kind of under-the-hood internet security scare that makes everyone wonder what else they've clicked on today.*

- Report centers on **8 compromised TLS certificates** discovered and circulating online
- TLS certs are the behind-the-scenes trust system that powers the little **padlock icon** in your browser
- Story's gaining traction on **Reddit's r/technology**, but hard details are still thin

The Everyday Impact Check

- Most people have no idea what a TLS cert even is until a story like this hits — so what's the one thing listeners should actually do about it today?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://arstechnica.com/security/2026/10/the-internet-goes-on-high-alert-after-discovery-of-8-compromised-tls-certs/

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■■ *Mark Ruffalo endorses Prop 40: "It's a one-time 5% tax on the wealth of California's billionaires. They can afford it." He warns that Props 41 and 42 are billionaire-funded countermeasures designed to nullify it.*

The Angle: *The Hulk just waded into California ballot politics, telling fans to back a one-time wealth tax on billionaires while warning two other measures are secretly funded by the ultra-rich to cancel it out - that's a juicy celebrity-meets-politics story made for debate.*

- **Mark Ruffalo** publicly endorsed **Prop 40**, calling it a **"one time 5% tax on the wealth of California's billionaires"**
- His pitch: **"They can afford it"**
- He claims **Props 41 and 42** are billionaire-funded countermeasures designed to **"trick you"** and nullify Prop 40
- Ruffalo ties the urgency to healthcare, saying **"public health clinics in Los Angeles County are already shutting down"

The Debate Starter

- Does a celebrity endorsement change your vote on a ballot measure, or does it make you trust it less?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/l04w7x5gcqwh1

Backup options:

■ *A 1970s heart treatment that squeezes your legs with inflatable cuffs improved memory and thinking in 84% of people with early Alzheimer's in a 190-person trial. Most patients actually got better than where they started, not just slower decline, and 75% still had gains 6 months after treatment ended*

The Angle: *This is the kind of health story people clip and send to their group chat — a weirdly simple device actually *improving* memory in Alzheimer's patients, not just slowing the slide. That's a big deal and worth a quick lifestyle hit.*

- Trial involved **190 people** with early Alzheimer's
- **84%** of patients saw improved memory and thinking
- Most patients got better than their starting baseline — not just slower decline
- **75%** still showed gains **6 months** after treatment stopped

The Watercooler Moment

- Would you try a weird old device on your legs if there was a real shot it could sharpen your mind?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sciencealert.com/this-heart-treatment-from-the-1970s-could-also-improve-memory-in-alzheimers-patients

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■ *In teenagers (mean age 12.6 years) one additional serve of any type of fruit each day was associated with a 13% lower risk of depression and a 7% lower risk of anxiety over the study period, according to a study on 6537 Australian adolescents followed for 3 years*

The Angle: *Parents are always looking for an easy win against teen mental health struggles, and this study suggests something as simple as tossing an extra banana in the lunch bag could actually move the needle.*

- Researchers tracked **6,537 Australian teens**, average age **12.6**, for **3 years**
- Just **one extra serving of fruit per day** was linked to a **13% lower risk of depression**
- That same extra serving was tied to a **7% lower risk of anxiety**
- The findings held for **any type of fruit**, not one specific superfood

The Debate Starter

- Is this a real fix or just 'eat your veggies' advice dressed up in a study - would you actually bribe your kid with fruit to boost their mood?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sydney.edu.au/news-opinion/news/2026/10/19/an-extra-serve-of-fruit-linked-to-lower-risk-of-depression-and-anxiety-in-teenagers.html

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CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

■ *Colorado's wildlife crossing system cut wildlife collisions on Interstate 25 by 91%. A stretch that averaged 32 crashes a year has seen just two in 10 months, while a 200 foot wide bridge covered in grass reconnects 39,000 acres of habitat with five underpasses and miles of fencing.*

The Angle: *A feel-good infrastructure win people can actually picture - a grassy overpass for elk and deer that turned one of Colorado's deadliest highway stretches into one of its safest. Perfect close-the-show, humans-doing-something-right story.*

- Interstate 25 stretch used to average **32 wildlife crashes a year**

- Over the last **10 months**, that number dropped to just **2 crashes**
- The centerpiece is a **200-foot-wide bridge** covered in grass, built just for animals to cross
- The whole system reconnects **39,000 acres** of habitat using **5 underpasses** and miles of fencing

The Feel-Good Finish

- A 91% drop just by giving deer their own bridge - sometimes the simplest fix is the right one.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.autonocion.com/us/200-foot-wildlife-bridge-colorado-interstate-two-animals/

Backup options:

■ *An energy project is successfully storing electricity using a liquid 2.5 times denser than water, allowing pumped hydro to work on much lower hills than normal systems. The 500 kW demonstrator has operated at full power all year potentially opening thousands of new sites for long duration storage*

The Angle: *Pumped hydro storage usually needs big hills and reservoirs — this swaps water for a liquid **2.5 times denser**, so you get the same storage punch on way smaller terrain, which could massively expand where clean energy storage is even possible.*

- The demonstrator plant runs on a liquid **2.5 times denser than water**
- It's a **500 kW** system that's reportedly run at full power **all year**
- Because the dense fluid does more work per foot of drop, it works on **much lower hills** than traditional pumped hydro needs
- Backers say the tech could unlock **thousands of new potential sites** for long-duration energy storage

The Feel-Good Takeaway

- We spend so much time on doom-and-gloom energy news — this is the rare one where a weird science fix might actually make clean power easier to store, not harder.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ecoticias.com/en/a-small-devon-power-plant-uses-liquid-dense-enough-to-float-concrete-and-it-could-change-where-clean-energy-gets-stored/36507/

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 0/5 this month; TECH TALK 4/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 3/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■■ *Nicolas Cage battling sinkhole that threatens his Malibu home*

The Angle: *A giant hole in the ground trying to swallow a Nicolas Cage mansion is exactly the kind of absurd, real-life movie plot that makes for a perfect goodbye story - it's got his name on it, so it writes itself.*

- **Nicolas Cage** is reportedly dealing with a **sinkhole** threatening his **Malibu** home.
- Story surfaced via **r/nottheonion**, the subreddit for real headlines too wild to believe.
- Malibu's coastal bluffs are notorious for erosion and land-shift issues, so this isn't shocking - just perfectly timed for a guy named **Cage**.

The Obvious Joke

- You cannot make this up - a man named Cage is trapped in a real-life disaster movie about his own house.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.detroitnews.com/story/news/nation/2026/10/19/nicolas-cage-sinkhole-malibu-oceanfront-home/92339118007/

■ *Meta Ignores Brazilian Court Order to End Bolsonaro Favoritism*

The Angle: *Meta Ignores Brazilian Court Order to End Bolsonaro Favoritism*

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.panamericandispatch.org/p/meta-ignores-brazilian-court-order

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■■ *US restarts three shut-down nuclear reactors to feed AI data centers — 2.25 GW coming online with backing from Microsoft and Google*

The Angle: *Big Tech's AI boom is so power-hungry it's literally reviving dead nuclear reactors — a wild sign of how much energy data centers actually eat, and a story with real stakes for everyone's power bill.*

- **Three** previously shut-down nuclear reactors in the US are being restarted
- Combined, they'll add **2.25 gigawatts** of power to the grid
- **Microsoft** and **Google** are backing the restarts to fuel their AI data centers
- Marks a notable reversal — these plants were offline before AI demand changed the math

The Debate Starter

- Is it wild or genius that chatbots are bringing nuclear power plants back from the dead?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.tomshardware.com/tech-industry/big-tech/us-takes-unprecedented-step-of-recommissioning-nuclear-plants-due-to-ai-power-demand-2-25-gw-currently-on-tap-from-refurbished-reactors

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BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ *Man who lost legs to MS warming heads and hearts by knitting tuques on custom-made cot | CBC News*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A double amputee knitting tuques from a custom cot is a vivid, specific visual with a built-in emotional payoff that tends to travel well as a short clip.

The Angle: *It's the kind of pure, no-catch feel-good story that cuts through the news cycle — a Canadian man turned a devastating diagnosis into a one-of-a-kind knitting setup, and people can't get enough of it.*

- He lost **both legs** to **multiple sclerosis (MS)**
- Rigged up a **custom-made cot** so he can keep knitting
- Makes **tuques** (that's Canadian for winter hats, for anyone south of the border)
- Story is out of **CBC News**, catching fire on **r/upliftingnews**

The Heart-Warmer

- Ask listeners: who in your life turned a hard diagnosis into something that helps other people?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/manitoba/senior-custom-cot-knitting-tuques-9.7382128

■ *Victorian Premier Ben Carroll admits to accidentally doing a runner after filling up car*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A sitting Premier admitting he accidentally drove off without paying for gas is a self-contained, named-official gaffe with instant meme/clip potential.

The Angle: *A sitting head of a state government fessing up to accidentally driving off without paying for gas is the kind of relatable, slightly embarrassing mishap that makes a powerful person instantly human - and it's*

tailor-made for a laugh on air.

- **Ben Carroll**, Premier of **Victoria** (Australia's version of a state Premier - think the equivalent of a Governor), admitted to accidentally **filling up his car and driving off without paying**.
- He called it an honest mistake, not a deliberate dodge.
- Story's blowing up partly because of the sheer irony: the guy in charge of the state got caught in the most everyday screwup imaginable.

The Confession Starter

- Phone lines: have you ever driven off from the pump before paying - and how long before you realized?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.news.com.au/national/victoria/politics/victorian-premier-ben-carroll-admits-to-accidentally-doing-a-runner-after-filling-up-car/news-story/4aec6e2aa8a31d74654c729c434ec41d

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■ *Bono Believes Republican Party Has Been "Hijacked" and Wants "To Invite Them Back"*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Bono weighing in on the GOP being 'hijacked' is a surprising political statement from a huge, unexpected celebrity name that cable/political Twitter will likely pick up.
The Angle: *U2's frontman wading into U.S. politics is classic rockstar-meets-Washington chaos, and the "hijacked party" line is tailor-made for a reaction bit.*

- **Bono** says the **Republican Party** has been **"hijacked"**
- He says he wants **"to invite them back"**
- Comment comes from U2 frontman, a longtime dabbler in political activism and diplomacy

The Debate Starter

- Does a rock star lecturing a political party ever actually land, or does it just prove he's out of touch?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://consequence.net/2026/10/bono-talks-about-republican-party/

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 3 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Claude Allegedly Let a Digital Grandma Die Rather Than Recite Justin Bieber Lyrics in a Bizarre AI Test" (Reddit r/nottheonion, banked 2026-10-19)
- "Dan Quinn 'definitely knew it was 4th down' after lip readers questioned Commanders bizarre play" (nypost.com, banked 2026-10-20)
- "HUNTER: Hug-a-thug judges hit daily double of bizarre decisions" (torontosun.com, banked 2026-10-20)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 17 banked (+15 each when found)
- "A top QB showdown and a historic anniversary: 5 things to know from the NFL this week - CNN" (CNN (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-10-02)
- "Banjo-Kazooie PC port developer blasts AI vibe coding as retro gaming fills with low-quality ports" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-10-07)
- "30 of the Most Fool-Proof (and Romantic) Anniversary Gifts for Him" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-10-12)
- "The Atari 800XL is back as a $220 retro machine with a real keyboard, HDMI, and a working cartridge slot" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-10-12)
- "'Three Days Of Rain' Broadway Revival With François Arnaud, David Corenswet & Yvonne Strahovski Sets Opening Date, Venue" (deadline.com, banked 2026-10-13)
- "Why the 'Girls' Revival Is Such an Exciting Idea" (variety.com, banked 2026-10-13)
- "Why the 'Girls' Revival Is Such an Exciting Idea https://t.co/lTSfPsejyB" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-10-13)
- "London society frets as King Charles skips major high-culture event" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-10-16)
- "Olivia Rodrigo and Chappell Roan Compete on Game Shows Hosted by David Byrne in the Retro Video for 'Expectations' Remix https://t.co/sBX7jh" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-10-16)
- "Olivia Rodrigo Taps Chappell Roan (and David Byrne) for Retro 'Expectations' Remix" (www.rollingstone.com, banked 2026-10-16)

- "Seahawks vs. Broncos, ‘Thursday Night Football’ game chat and live discussion - Field Gulls" (Field Gulls (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-10-16)
- "Iron Maiden Announce Surprise 2027 North American Tour" (www.rollingstone.com, banked 2026-10-18)
- "‘Other Desert Cities’ Theater Review: Julia Louis-Dreyfus, Ed Harris and Allison Janney Fail to Make a Once-Timely Play Relevant Again" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-10-19)
- "Rita Wilson Says She’s Returning for Lena Dunham’s ‘Girls’ Revival: ‘I Would Do Anything for Her’" (variety.com, banked 2026-10-19)
- "Rita Wilson Teases Return In Lena Dunham’s ‘Girls’ Revival On HBO: “I Would Do Anything For Her”" (deadline.com, banked 2026-10-19)
- "82WORLD: LA Best Moments: ATEEZ Brings It Home, P1Harmony’s Big Tease and a BTS Throwback" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-10-20)
- "82WORLD: LA Best Moments: ATEEZ Brings It Home, P1Harmony’s Big Tease and a BTS Throwback" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-10-20)

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @globalnews (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)
- 1 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

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